

KNOW YOURSELF: INTERESTS

Have you heard this advice: *Follow your passion and you will find your career?* **Following your passion implies that you have one. But many people don't.** What did you enjoy at age 10? What activity makes you lose track of time.

Simply start with an interest.

According to the vocational theory developed by John Holland, the activities people engage in and the work environments in American society can be categorized by a set of common characteristics. The more compatible a person's interests are with the work environment, the greater success and satisfaction the individual is likely to experience. The same can be said for your choice of academic program—the greater your interest in the subject, the more successful you will be academically.



EXERCICE 1: INTERESTS CHECKLIST

Follow the directions to identify your preferred Holland Interest Themes.

1. Check the boxes for the activities that sound appealing to you whether you have done them or not. **Do not consider your skill, only your interest in the activity.**

Realistic Theme (R)	Investigative Theme (I)
☐ Go hiking or camping ☐ Operate large machinery or precision tools ☐ Assemble, repair, or network computers Plant a garden ☐ Lead a fitness class Raise or train animals ☐ Find solutions to mechanical problems ☐ Work on a construction site ☐ Take an engineering class Serve in the military ☐ Repair or tune up bikes, cars, or	☐ Solve math problems or quizzes ☐ Work with a chemistry set ☐ Read and solve mysteries ☐ Develop a survey questionnaire for a research project ☐ Read scientific books or watch scientific documentaries ☐ Work in a laboratory ☐ Learn a new computer programming language ☐ Compare and analyze budget figures ☐ Observe behavioral or scientific

motorcycles ☐ Plan outdoor recreational activities Provide safety during an emergency	phenomena Use a microscope or telescope ☐ Play chess or other strategy games ☐ Analyze and solve abstract problems ☐ Collect and analyze data for an experiment
Total:	Total:

Artistic Theme (A)	Enterprising Theme (E)
☐ Design posters, flyers, or brochures ☐ Write an article or report the news ☐ Work creatively in an unstructured environment ☐ Think of new ways to solve problems or accomplish tasks ☐ Sketch, draw, paint, or sculpt ☐ Read or write poetry ☐ Dance or act in a play ☐ Attend a play, opera, or concert ☐ Design a dress, piece of jewelry, or furniture ☐ Play a musical instrument ☐ Visit an art exhibit or museum ☐ Write a creative story for fun or publication ☐ Create decorative food displays	☐ Give a speech or presentation ☐ Compete in a game or contest ☐ Lead a work project or committee ☐ Sell items or services ☐ Participate in a political campaign ☐ Help settle disputes ☐ Be a member of the debate team ☐ Own or operate a small business or service ☐ Manage a fundraising campaign for an organization ☐ Entertain business clients ☐ Serve as a club officer ☐ Supervise a staff of people ☐ Persuade others to accept your ideas
Total:	Total:
Social Theme (S)	Conventional Theme (C)
☐ Take a social sciences course (e.g., psychology or sociology) ☐ Provide care for children or adults who need assistance ☐ Belong to clubs or attend conferences and networking meetings ☐ Help someone new become acquainted with others and make friends ☐ Teach a class or a workshop	☐ Fill out income tax forms ☐ Take notes during a meeting ☐ Maintain the records for a club, or serve as treasurer in a club ☐ Create a digital filing system to make it more organized ☐ Write business letters, memos, or reports ☐ Work with numbers, financial data, and spreadsheets ☐ Collect and organize items such

☐ Organize social events ☐ Learn about different cultures and groups of people ☐ Listen to your friends' personal problems and try to help solve them ☐ Do volunteer or community service work ☐ Train a new employee ☐ Mentor a young person ☐ Lead a discussion group on social justice ☐ Collaborate on group projects	as stamps, international coins, or baseball cards ☐ Update software and test new computer programs ☐ Create a budget and manage personal finances ☐ Make charts and graphs ☐ Take or keep an inventory of supplies ☐ Prepare agendas and schedules ☐ Develop and follow efficient work routines
Total:	Total:

- Count up your checkmarks for each theme. What are the three themes with the highest number of checks?
- Identify your first, second, and third most appealing themes. This is your Holland Code. For instance, SAC means: Social, Artistic, and Conventional.

Write your code here:

Work environments can be divided into six broad interest areas: Realistic, Investigative, Artistic, Social, Enterprising, and Conventional. Knowing your unique combination of interests can assist you in determining jobs that suit you best.

LINK YOUR INTERESTS TO ACADEMIC PROGRAMS AND CAREERS

To learn more about your Holland Code and how to use this information when considering an academic program or future career:

- Check the table on the next page for a quick reference
- Schedule an appointment with our advisors at **link to be added**



HOLLAND THEMES

AREA		DESCRIPTION	ACTIVITIES	ACADEMIC PROGRAMS
R	Realistic (Expresses interests and solves problems by doing) DOER	Enjoys working with machines, tools, objects, and animals Practical, reserved, and physical Likes to work outdoors on concrete problems and see tangible results	Club ASCE (Civil Engineering Student Chapter)	Mechanical Engineer Civil Engineer Chemical and Petrochemical Engineer Laboratory Scientist Nutrition and Dietetics
I	Investigative (Expresses interests and solves problems by thinking) THINKER	Enjoys researching, exploring ideas, collecting data, analyzing, inquiring, and using instruments Methodical, original, and logical	Student Council research-type engagements and Campus-J (student newspaper) Club Berytus (History club)	Biology, Biochemistry Economics Mathematics Pre-med Computer or Electrical Engineering Computer Science
A	Artistic (Expresses interests and solves problems by creating)	Enjoys being original, independent, introspective, self-expressive, innovative, and unstructured Develops skills in	Club Photographie Daraj al Yassouiyeh Festival Talent Show	Art and Visual Technology Translation Foreign Languages Film Production & Media Management

	CREATOR	music, art, drama, language, and writing	TedX-USJ	
S	Social (Expresses interests and solves problems by helping) HELPER	Enjoys working with people to inform, train, enlighten, or cure Perceptive, responsible, empathetic, and patient	Model United Nations	Education Global Affairs Nursing Psychology Social Work
E	Enterprising (Expresses interests and solves problems by persuading) PERSUADER	Seeks to use mind, words, and feelings in dealing with people to motivate, persuade, manage, and sell things or promote ideas May like taking personal or financial risks Assertive, sociable, ambitious, enthusiastic, influential, and goal-oriented	Model United Nations USJ en Mission Agora Club	Human Resources Law Management Public Administration Tourism and Events Management
C	Conventional (Expresses interests and solves problems by organizing) ORGANIZER	Enjoys activities that permit organization of information in a clear, orderly manner Likes structured settings Is detail-oriented, responsible, and conforming	Career-focused events via USJ CONNECT Student Council	Accounting Finance Data Management Information Technology Banking & Economics